

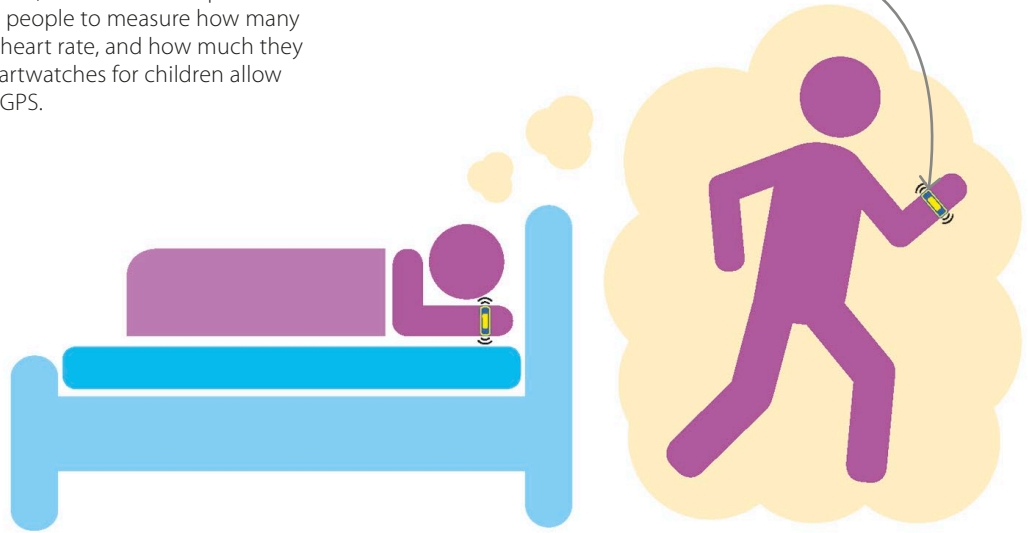
Activity trackers

Since smartwatches have many integrated sensors, they often come equipped with apps that are designed to monitor health-related data. Activity trackers are also available, which function similarly to smartwatches, but without the phone or paying capabilities. Apps allow people to measure how many steps they take each day, their heart rate, and how much they sleep, among other things. Smartwatches for children allow their parents to track them via GPS.

Fitness trackers can collect data about the length, type, and intensity of the user's exercise workouts.

▷ Sensors

The integrated sensors in a smartwatch can include accelerometers, heart-rate monitors, light sensors, thermometers, and sensors that measure the level of oxygen in a user's blood.

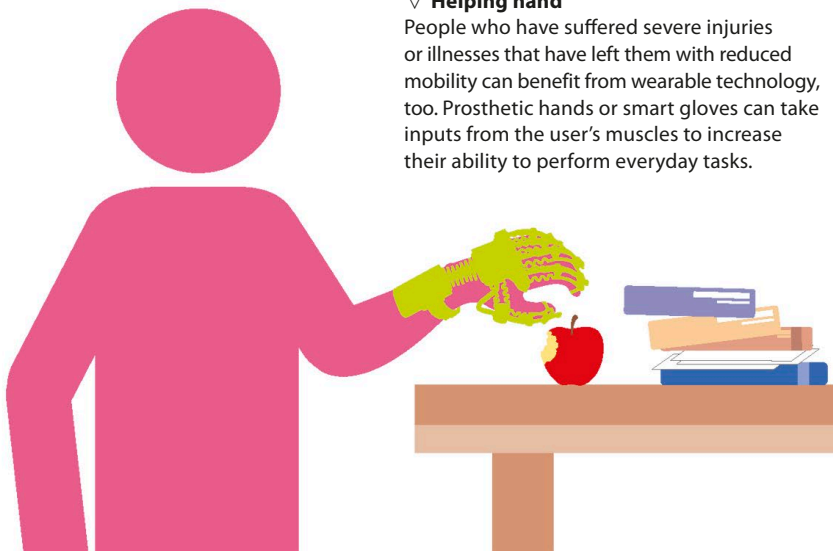


Healthcare and industry

Wearable computers have a number of potential uses in healthcare and in the workplace. Sensors worn on the skin can be used to monitor a diabetic user's blood glucose levels. Google Glass – a pair of smart glasses that project digital information over the wearer's field of vision – is being tested as an aid to help factory workers assemble complex items.

▽ Helping hand

People who have suffered severe injuries or illnesses that have left them with reduced mobility can benefit from wearable technology, too. Prosthetic hands or smart gloves can take inputs from the user's muscles to increase their ability to perform everyday tasks.



REAL WORLD

Criminal justice

Many countries employ an electronic tagging system that uses devices worn on the ankle to restrict people convicted of crimes to their homes or another area. The devices use GPS signals to track the convicted person and signal to police if they leave the designated area. There are even electronic tagging systems that are able to detect whether the user has consumed alcohol or drugs.

